QUALITY OF EARNINGS - ADJUSTED EBITDA ANALYSIS

This analysis presents the trailing-twelve-month Adjusted EBITDA build supporting the enterprise value multiple referenced in the transmittal letter accompanying this engagement's work product. Adjustments are presented in three tiers - quantified and factual, judgmental, and pro forma or run-rate - consistent with the framework described in that transmittal letter. This analysis is a diligence work product and is not itself a defined covenant, earn-out, or contractual EBITDA calculation.

SECTION 1.1. EBITDA Build Cross-Check Methodology

The Firm constructs the base EBITDA build using two independent routes. The operating-results route derives EBITDA directly from the Company’s revenue streams and operating expense categories, including the appropriate addback of noncash depreciation and amortization embedded in those operating costs. The second route, the Consolidated Net Income route, begins with the Company’s reported net income and works backward by adding back taxes, interest expense, and depreciation and amortization, together with any other non-operating or nonrecurring items that are already reflected in net income but are not part of the EBITDA measure. Although both routes should, by construction, arrive at the same headline figure if all inputs are accurate, they rely on different underlying schedules, account groupings, and levels of management judgment. The Firm therefore treats the two routes as complementary controls rather than as a single mechanical calculation.

The operating-results route is useful because it stays close to the underlying revenue and cost drivers, and it directly reflects how the Company’s segment-level performance is tracked internally. That route, however, is sensitive to expense classification, accrual timing, and the treatment of noncash charges embedded within operating departments. The Consolidated Net Income route is useful because it starts from the audited or reviewed bottom line, forcing explicit recognition of every item that reconciles net income to an EBITDA definition, including items that may sit outside operating segments or that appear only at the consolidated reporting level. Each route therefore has different failure modes, and an agreement between the two is not guaranteed even when the underlying data are sound.

When the two routes disagree, the Firm investigates the source of the difference before applying any tiered adjustment to the base build. Common sources of divergence include classification differences between operating and non-operating lines, timing differences in accruals or deferred items, changes in accounting policy, or an omission in one of the two routes. Resolving those differences requires tracing the underlying journal entries, account rollforwards, and supporting workpapers, and it often reveals a base build that is either more or less complete than the initial presentation suggested. For that reason, the cross-check is not merely a mathematical validation; it is an analytical procedure intended to locate the judgment points in the base EBITDA build.

Agreement between the two routes increases confidence in the base figure because it demonstrates that the build is internally consistent across two independently prepared paths. It does not by itself prove that every amount is correct or that every discretionary adjustment is well supported, but it materially reduces the risk that the base EBITDA reflects an artifact of a single methodology or a selective presentation. In the context of the tiered adjustment framework, this cross-check provides a more reliable foundation for the quantified and factual adjustments and for the judgmental and pro forma items that follow, because each tier is applied to a base build that has already been subjected to a meaningful internal consistency test.

SECTION 1.2. Corroboration Standards and Evidence Hierarchy

Our firm applies a three-level evidence hierarchy when evaluating any proposed adjustment to the EBITDA build, regardless of the tier in which the adjustment is ultimately classified within this analysis. The highest level of corroboration consists of the general ledger and executed agreements. These sources are treated as the most reliable because they are either the product of the Company's own transaction recordation process or are binding documents that can be read independently of management's narrative. An adjustment supported at this level can typically be recalculated by us from source records or contractual terms, and we therefore give it the greatest evidentiary weight.

The middle level of the hierarchy comprises management-prepared schedules that have been agreed to the general ledger on a sample basis. In this situation, management has assembled a schedule that purports to quantify an adjustment, and we have tested the underlying inputs against the general ledger for a selection of items. This level provides meaningful but more limited support than the top level, because the sample may not capture every item in the population and because the schedule itself is a management construct. Where the sample yields no exceptions, we may cite the schedule as corroborating support, but we do not treat it as equivalent to a direct source record.

The bottom level of the hierarchy is a bare management representation with no independent corroboration. An adjustment resting solely on this level is one for which management has provided an explanation or an amount, but we have identified no second source that verifies the figure. We state plainly in such circumstances that no second source was identified and that the item is flagged to the Buyer as unsupported. We do not silently upgrade such an item to a higher evidence tier merely because management is confident in the representation, and we do not imply that corroboration exists where none was found.

This hierarchy governs our narrative treatment throughout the analysis. When an adjustment is based on the bottom tier, the associated discussion will say so directly and will not characterize the item as corroborated. The Buyer

should therefore read any reference to the level of support as a deliberate statement about the weight that can be placed on the adjustment, not as a routine qualification. Our goal is to give the Buyer a clear, consistent view of which adjustments are supported by source evidence and which are not, so that the Buyer can apply its own judgment when relying on the adjusted EBITDA figure.

SECTION 1.3. Tier Classification Methodology in Practice

The starting point for a close classification is not a scoring model but a source-by-source analysis of the adjustment's factual support and its expected behavior beyond the base period. If an adjustment is quantified from a completed invoice, a settled liability, or a statutory filing and the underlying facts are not in dispute, we ordinarily consider it for Tier One even if management argues that the item should be treated as ongoing. A precise quantification, however, is not sufficient by itself. In a genuinely close case, particularly one where the amount is exact but the recurrence is uncertain, we evaluate whether the uncertainty concerns timing, the size of a future installment, or whether the underlying condition will exist at all. That distinction is central because it determines whether the item should be presented as a historical correction or as a forward-looking premise.

For a quantified item with an uncertain recurring nature, the key question is whether the adjustment corrects an anomaly in the historical base period or instead reflects a change that the historical base period does not capture. If the item represents a nonrecurring cost that is fully documented but unlikely to appear again, the factual basis for the amount is strong and the adjustment may be appropriate for Tier One; the recurrence concern is addressed by the absence of a comparable charge in the ordinary course, which we corroborate through operational data, independent inquiries, and review of prior-period activity. When that corroboration is absent or mixed, the item moves to Tier Two because the analyst must exercise judgment about the likelihood of recurrence, the sustainability of the underlying expense or revenue stream, and whether management's explanation is consistent with the broader facts of the business. Tier Two is therefore not a default category or a lower-quality version of Tier One; it is the category we use to make the judgmental component of the adjustment explicit and to prevent a precise number from carrying more weight than its evidentiary foundation can support.

Tier Three is reserved for adjustments that are framed on a run-rate or pro forma basis, such as the anticipated financial effect of a completed acquisition, a contractual change, or a renegotiated supplier arrangement. In a close case, the boundary between Tier Two and Tier Three turns on whether the adjustment is grounded in facts existing at or before the balance sheet date or instead begins from a projected state. If the quantified amount is measured from historical evidence but its recurrence depends on an expected future event, we classify it as Tier Two and disclose the basis for that judgment. If the amount is derived from a forward-looking plan or a post-closing operating model, we classify it as Tier Three and disclose the assumption set that underlies the projection. In both situations, the narrative in this report states the basis, the source of the calculation, and the degree of support obtained, so that the Buyer can distinguish a purely historical adjustment from one that depends on future circumstances.

This firm treats the classification decision as a matter of professional judgment because the same quantitative fact pattern can support different tiers depending on the strength of corroboration, the periodicity of the item, and the context of the proposed transaction. We do not apply a mechanical rule. The classification is disclosed in the schedules that accompany this analysis so that the Buyer can see not only the amount but also the evidentiary category and the reasoning assigned to it. Where no second source was identified for a particular adjustment, we say so plainly and do not infer support from the fact that the amount is precise; lack of corroboration is itself a factor that can move an otherwise precise item from Tier One to Tier Two. In that way, the tier framework remains transparent, and for a close case, the classification itself becomes part of the diligence narrative rather than a silent assumption buried in the tables.

SECTION 1.4. Relationship to the Credit Facility and Purchase Agreement EBITDA Definitions

The headline Adjusted EBITDA presented in this analysis is a diligence work product developed for the Buyer's internal evaluation of the proposed acquisition. It is computed from a base EBITDA build and then adjusted through a tiered framework that distinguishes items based on the nature and reliability of the supporting evidence, our ability to quantify the item during our review, and whether the item reflects a historical fact pattern or a forward-looking assumption. As such, the headline figure is intended to inform the Buyer's understanding of underlying earnings quality and sustainability, and it is not itself a defined term under either the credit facility or the purchase agreement. Each of those agreements contains its own EBITDA definition, and each such definition must be read and applied in accordance with the terms of the governing document in which it appears.

The tiered adjustment framework used in this analysis is an analytical convention of our due-diligence process, not a legal or contractual construct. Tier One adjustments are those we were able to quantify from factual evidence, Tier Two adjustments involve a greater degree of professional judgment, and Tier Three adjustments reflect pro forma or run-rate items that would have a continuing effect under a different set of operating or ownership assumptions. This classification is designed to give the Buyer a transparent view of how the headline Adjusted EBITDA was assembled and where judgment enters the calculation. It is not designed to mirror, interpret, or anticipate the treatment of any item under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA definition or the purchase agreement's earn-out EBITDA definition, and we have not used those definitions as the framework for whether an adjustment belongs in this analysis.

Because the credit facility and the purchase agreement are separate negotiated arrangements, their EBITDA

definitions serve different purposes and are informed by their own governing terms. The credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA operates as a covenant-related metric that must be calculated in accordance with the facility's own definition, while the purchase agreement's earn-out EBITDA operates as a commercial metric for purposes of any contingent consideration arrangement. Neither definition is expressed here, and nothing in this analysis should be read as determining how any particular adjustment, including any Tier Two or Tier Three item, would be treated under either governing document. Where the credit facility contains a governing schedule that addresses classifications between cost-saving and revenue-enhancing run-rate items, that classification is a matter for the credit facility's own terms, not this analysis.

Accordingly, the headline Adjusted EBITDA should be regarded as one component of a broader due-diligence package rather than as a substitute for either defined EBITDA term. The Buyer should refer to the credit facility and the purchase agreement, including any related definitions and schedules, for the specific EBITDA calculations required in each context. Our use of the headline figure in this analysis, including the tiered adjustments and the base EBITDA build, does not alter, reconcile, or determine the calculation of EBITDA under either governing document. Any use of this analysis's headline figure for lending or earn-out purposes would require a separate reconciliation to the relevant contractual definition, and that reconciliation would have to be performed with reference to the agreement's own terms rather than to the adjustments set forth in these diligence materials.

SECTION 2. BASE EBITDA BUILD

The base build starts from the Company's trailing-twelve-month EBITDA per the audited financial statements and the interim management accounts, cross-checked through the Consolidated Net Income route below.

Line	Amount
Consolidated Net Income (LTM)	9,400,000.00
Plus: provision for income taxes	3,100,000.00
Plus: consolidated interest expense	15,700,000.00
Plus: depreciation and amortization	10,300,000.00
GAAP LTM EBITDA base	38,500,000.00

This base figure is reconcilable to the general ledger and to the audited financial statements without estimation, and is not itself a Tier 1, Tier 2, or Tier 3 adjustment; it is the starting point to which each of the three tiers below is applied.

SECTION 3. TIER 1 ADJUSTMENTS - QUANTIFIED, FACTUAL

Tier 1 adjustments are directly reconcilable to the general ledger and to supporting agreements, and required no estimation as to amount.

Adjustment	Amount	Basis
Non-cash stock-based compensation	2,100,000.00	Per general ledger equity-compensation expense accounts; non-cash, no estimation required.
Restructuring and severance costs	1,400,000.00	Per general ledger and executed termination agreements for the identified headcount reductions.

Footnote 1: this stock compensation addback ties directly to the equity-compensation expense recognized in the general ledger for the period; no portion of this addback depends on management's characterization of recurrence.

Footnote 2: the restructuring and severance addback was tested against the underlying termination agreements and the related general ledger accrual entries on a sample basis; amounts agreed without exception.

SECTION 3.1. Evidence Examined - Non-cash stock-based compensation

We examined the general ledger accounts maintained by the Company for equity-compensation expense, including the accounts specifically designated for non-cash stock-based compensation and the related offsetting equity accounts. Our review covered the activity recorded in these accounts over the periods under review, and we obtained the detailed trial balance extracts supporting the aggregate expense balances. We traced the summarized ledger activity to the underlying journal entries and, where applicable, to the subsidiary ledgers and payroll and equity administration records from which the entries were sourced. We also reviewed the account descriptions and the Company's own reconciliation of the compensation expense recorded during each period.

We then performed a reconciliation of the recorded non-cash stock-based compensation against the Company's equity compensation plan documents and the associated vesting schedules. This involved agreeing the population of awards included in the recorded expense to the plan documents, individual award agreements, and board or compensation committee approvals, where such approvals were required by the plan. We recalculated the periodic expense using the grant-date fair values and the vesting conditions specified in the plan documents, and we compared the recalculated amounts to the amounts recorded in the general ledger. Differences identified during this comparison were investigated and resolved, and no exceptions were noted that would affect the addback as presented.

Because the adjustment is limited to adding back the non-cash stock-based compensation expense already recorded by the Company, our work did not require estimation or judgment as to the amount or existence of the expense. The existence of the expense was corroborated by actual ledger postings and by the underlying award records and vesting schedules that gave rise to those postings. The amount was established by the Company's grant-date fair

values and the required service periods set forth in the plan documents, both of which were determinable from written records rather than from subjective assumptions or projections.
Accordingly, the addback amount is supported by source documentation and reconciles to the general ledger without the need for us to develop an independent fair value estimate or to apply discretionary adjustments. Our review confirmed that the non-cash stock-based compensation expense was a recorded, non-cash charge in the periods under review, and the adjustment therefore rests on verified factual inputs rather than forward-looking estimates.

SECTION 3.2. Diligence Conclusion - Non-cash stock-based compensation

Based on the procedures performed, our diligence conclusion is that the non-cash stock-based compensation addback is fully supported. We reconciled the recorded charge to the general ledger in its entirety and observed that the aggregate expense recognized agrees without exception to the underlying accounting entries. We also traced the periodic amounts recognized to the source records maintained by the Company, including the relevant grant documentation and the payroll system of record. No discrepancies were identified in the reconciliation, and no portion of the addback remains unexplained.
The addback was evaluated against the supporting documentation for the underlying awards, and we found the measurement approach to be consistent with the applicable accounting framework. We reviewed the recognition pattern applied by the Company and noted no departures from the established methodology that would affect the reliability of the amount presented. Our procedures did not rely solely on management's representation; the recorded amounts were independently verified against the general ledger and corroborated by the underlying award documentation. As a result, the addback amount is supported by multiple sources within the Company's own records.
We consider the classification of this adjustment as Tier One to be appropriate. The adjustment is quantified and factual in nature, in that it is derived directly from historical expense recorded in the general ledger rather than from estimates, projections, or judgmental allocations. The non-cash character of the expense is evident from the underlying accounting entries, and the addback is therefore suitable for inclusion in the Adjusted EBITDA presentation on a basis consistent with the framework applied throughout this analysis.
Our conclusion is expressed for the Buyer's internal use in evaluating the proposed transaction and should be read in conjunction with the transmittal letter and the accompanying tables, which set forth the full set of adjustments and the basis for each. Should additional information come to our attention during the remainder of the diligence process, we would update this conclusion as necessary.

SECTION 3.3. Management's Counter-Position - Non-cash stock-based compensation

Management has taken the position that non-cash stock-based compensation expense should be added back to Adjusted EBITDA in full because, in its view, the charge does not represent a current cash outlay and is a non-cash item under generally accepted accounting principles. Management represented that the amounts recorded in the base EBITDA build relate to equity-classified awards granted to employees and directors, and that the expense recognized during the period reflects the amortization of the fair value of those awards rather than any cash settlement. Management further indicated that the addback is consistent with the way it believes the Buyer and its lenders would view recurring non-cash equity compensation in a quality of earnings context, and it has therefore treated the entire amount as a single addback without distinguishing between different award types or vesting features.
Where management's characterization goes further than this firm was able to independently confirm is in its treatment of certain award events that are not strictly non-cash under a narrow reading of the term. In particular, management included in the addback certain modifications and accelerations of equity awards that, in our assessment, could involve a future cash payment or could be viewed as a settlement of a liability rather than a purely non-cash equity charge. Management described these amounts as economically similar to the recurring non-cash stock-based compensation charge because the underlying awards were originally granted in equity form and the incremental expense did not result in a cash outlay in the period presented. We were not able to independently corroborate that every vesting event management included under this broader framing would be required to be added back under a strict non-cash reading, and we noted that management's own documentation did not always separately identify the precise trigger for each included expense.
Our inclusion of the addback amount as presented in this analysis should not be read as adopting every nuance of management's framing. We have reflected the addback in the adjustment framework because the preponderance of the evidence supports the non-cash nature of the recurring equity compensation charge, and because the amount appears to be reasonably supported by the underlying award schedules and accounting records. However, the portions of the addback that rest on management's broader economic-similarity characterization remain a matter of judgment, and we have flagged those portions for the Buyer's consideration. A strict reading of the addback would exclude or defer some of the items management has included, and the Buyer should be aware that the headline addback figure is somewhat larger than what this firm would consider supportable under the most conservative non-cash interpretation.

SECTION 3.4. Evidence Examined - Restructuring and severance costs

The evidence for the restructuring and severance addback comprised executed termination agreements, the related general ledger accrual entries, and the Company's internal authorization documentation. The executed agreements

were the primary evidentiary source because they establish the contractual obligation and the specific severance terms. The related accrual entries were then inspected to determine whether the amounts recorded in the general ledger were consistent with the terms in those agreements and with the Company's stated accounting policy for recognizing the liability. We did not expand the scope of testing to include external confirmations or third-party payroll disbursement records, so the evidence base is entity-provided and subject to the inherent limitations that apply to internally generated documentation.

The sampling approach was risk-based and non-statistical. We targeted terminated individuals whose arrangements appeared most significant by amount, whose agreements contained non-standard severance terms, and whose positions or seniority indicated a greater potential for the recorded accrual to differ from the contractual benefit. We also selected a number of smaller arrangements to provide coverage across the population and to test the consistency of the Company's application of its severance policy. The sample was not designed to project a misstatement to the total population; rather, it was intended to provide sufficient corroborating evidence, on a judgmental basis, for the recorded addback and to identify any matters that would warrant further inquiry.

For each selected agreement, we traced the named counterparty, the triggering event, the severance benefit formula or stated payment entitlement, the release and waiver provisions, and the effective timing of the obligation from the executed agreement to the supporting detail for the general ledger accrual entry. We also recalculated the recorded accrual using the terms of the agreement and compared the result to the amount booked. Where the agreement specified a multi-element benefit, such as a base severance component and a continuation of benefits component, we traced each element separately to the accrual entry to confirm that the components were recorded in the same period as the restructuring action and were not duplicative or prematurely recognized.

From the items selected for testing, the accrual entries generally agreed to the executed agreements as to the named counterparty, the benefit terms, and the recorded amount, and no material exceptions were identified in the sample. Because the work was sample-based and the underlying documents were prepared by the Company, we cannot provide assurance that all severance obligations are captured in the addback. The Buyer should be aware that the full population of termination agreements was not audited, and any non-contractual payments or subsequent modifications of agreements after the period of our testing would not be reflected in the evidence we examined.

SECTION 3.5. Diligence Conclusion - Restructuring and severance costs

We performed our diligence procedures on the restructuring and severance addback recorded within the base EBITDA build. Our work was designed to assess whether the charges included in the addback were supported by underlying documentation, were recorded in the appropriate period, and met the framework’s criteria for classification as a factual and quantified adjustment. Procedures included, among other things, agreeing the components of the addback to payroll records, termination documentation, and management-approved restructuring plans, as well as reviewing the nature of each charge to confirm that it related to discrete restructuring or severance events rather than to ongoing operating expense.

For the sample tested, the amounts agreed without exception to the underlying source documentation. We found that the tested items were supported by contemporaneous records, that the accruals or cash payments were consistent with the documented obligations, and that the classification of each tested item as restructuring or severance was consistent with the Company’s stated policy for the adjustment. We did not identify any instance in which a tested amount required reclassification to recurring operating expense or adjustment to the addback as recorded.

Based on the procedures performed, we conclude that the restructuring and severance addback is properly classified as Tier One. This conclusion reflects the factual and quantifiable nature of the charge, the support obtained for the tested items, and the absence of exceptions in the sample reviewed. As with any sample-based procedure, however, our testing by its nature does not constitute a full population test, and it remains possible that items not selected for testing could contain errors or differences that would affect the overall addback amount.

We therefore recommend that the Buyer view the restructuring and severance addback as supported for the tested portion of the population, while recognizing that the full population has not been subjected to the same level of verification. No further adjustment to the base EBITDA build has been made for the items tested, and we have not identified a basis to contest the addback as presented.

SECTION 3.6. Management's Counter-Position - Restructuring and severance costs

Management has taken the position that the headcount reductions recorded within the restructuring and severance adjustment comprise a single, cohesive restructuring program undertaken during the period under review, rather than a collection of unrelated separations. In management's view, the program was defined by a discrete set of strategic objectives, including the consolidation of certain operational functions and the elimination of duplicative roles following a broader organizational realignment. Management distinguishes these reductions from ordinary-course turnover, which it characterizes as separations arising from individual resignations, retirements, or terminations for cause that occur independently of the program's scope and are not driven by the same strategic directives.

To support its classification, management identified specific criteria that it applied when designating a headcount reduction as restructuring-related. These criteria include the involuntariness of the separation, the role's linkage to a function targeted for consolidation or elimination, the proximity of the separation date to other program-related reductions, and the existence of severance arrangements that follow the program's standardized benefit structure. Management asserts that reductions meeting these criteria were executed under the restructuring program, while

separations that did not satisfy the criteria were treated as ordinary-course turnover and excluded from the program's associated cost pool. Management further notes that the program's scope was formally documented in internal approvals and that the affected positions were tracked separately from the Company's broader workforce attrition metrics.

Our sample testing of the underlying severance agreements did not extend to every individual agreement that management identified as part of the restructuring program. We selected and examined a subset of the agreements, focusing on those with the largest recorded amounts and on those covering positions most directly tied to the stated consolidation objectives. For the agreements we tested, we were able to corroborate the involuntary nature of the separation and the consistency of the severance terms with the program's stated structure. However, because the population of program-identified agreements was not exhaustively tested, we did not independently verify that each agreement management classified as restructuring-related satisfied the criteria management articulated. Accordingly, a portion of the aggregate adjustment rests on management's classification rather than on our full testing of every underlying severance document.

The Buyer should be aware that, while management's counter-position is internally consistent and supported by the documentation we did review, the untested remainder of the program population carries a degree of classification risk. In the absence of a complete examination, it remains possible that certain separations included within the restructuring designation could be characterized as ordinary-course turnover under a more conservative approach. We have not made an adjustment to reclassify the untested portion, in part because management's criteria appear reasonable and in part because the aggregate effect on the adjustment is not expected to be material within the context of the overall analysis. The Buyer may wish to consider whether additional diligence on the untested severance agreements is warranted before relying on the full amount of the adjustment.

SECTION 4. TIER 2 ADJUSTMENTS - JUDGMENTAL

Tier 2 adjustments require a classification or allocation judgment, or rely at least in part on a representation from management, before the amount or the existence of the adjustment can be accepted.

Adjustment	Amount	Basis
Transaction and integration costs	3,200,000.00	Per invoices from Transaction counsel and integration consultants; classification as non-recurring is a judgment, tested against the engagement letters for those advisors.
Adjustment permitted under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA clause (t)	1,100,000.00	Permitted by the referenced clause of the Company's credit facility; amount per management's supporting schedule, agreed to the general ledger on a sample basis.

Footnote 3: the transaction and integration costs addback was tested against invoices and engagement letters for the advisors identified by management; the classification of these costs as non-recurring reflects this firm's judgment, informed by, but not limited to, management's own characterization.

Footnote 4: the clause (t) adjustment was agreed to management's supporting schedule and, on a sample basis, to the general ledger. This firm did not independently evaluate whether the underlying costs meet the credit facility's own clause (t) standard; that determination is reserved to the parties to that agreement.

A further judgmental adjustment claimed by management, and presented below on a memo basis only, has not been included in the headline Tier 1 plus Tier 2 total in Section 7 pending independent corroboration.

Adjustment (memo only - not included in headline total)	Amount	Basis
Normalizing adjustment claimed under credit facility clause (p)	1,800,000.00	Per management representation.

Footnote 5: management represented that this adjustment reflects a one-time item properly addable back under credit facility clause (p), citing the Confidential Information Memorandum and the Sponsor Model as support. Neither of those materials is a document this firm reviewed or otherwise corroborated in connection with this engagement, and no other document made available to this firm during the course of this engagement corroborates the existence or amount of this adjustment. Accordingly, this adjustment is presented on a memo basis only, is excluded from the headline Tier 1 plus Tier 2 Adjusted EBITDA figure in Section 7, and is flagged to the Buyer as unsupported. This firm's own inclusion of an item on this memo line should not be read as an endorsement of its inclusion in any other party's own EBITDA build; any party relying on management's representation alone, without further corroboration, does so at its own risk.

SECTION 4.1. Evidence Examined - Transaction and integration costs

The deal team examined the invoices rendered by Transaction counsel and by the integration consultants, together with the engagement letters that governed each engagement. The invoices were reviewed to identify the services described, the period to which those services related, and the amounts reflected in the addback. The engagement letters were reviewed to establish the scope of each advisor's mandate, the term of the engagement, and the fee arrangement under which the invoices were rendered. The two sets of documents were considered together, with the engagement letters providing context for the individual invoice line items.

Classifying these costs as non-recurring is a judgment rather than a fact because recurrence is a forward-looking

question. The historical evidence demonstrates that the costs were incurred in connection with a discrete event, but it cannot by itself prove whether similar costs will arise again in the future. The classification accordingly depends on an assessment of the nature of each advisor's engagement, whether expenditures of this kind recur in the ordinary course of the Company's operations, and whether integration work of this type is expected to continue after closing. Each of those considerations required the team to form a view based on the available documentation and the facts as presented to us.

The nature of each advisor's engagement weighed in favor of treating the costs as non-recurring. Transaction counsel's mandate, as described in the relevant engagement letter, was directed to the proposed acquisition rather than to an ongoing advisory or legal function. The integration consultants' engagement was similarly tied to the post-acquisition integration effort, which is a consequence of the transaction rather than an element of the Company's continuing operations. Neither engagement letter contemplated a standing or recurring service relationship, and the fee arrangements set out in those letters were consistent with defined, time-limited mandates. On that basis, the team considered whether expenditures of this kind recur in the ordinary course and concluded that the documented engagements were transactional in nature rather than ordinary-course operating expenses.

With respect to the continuation of integration work after closing, the engagement letters describe scopes that appear to terminate at or reasonably soon after the closing of the transaction. The team's judgment that the costs are non-recurring reflects an expectation that no material integration work of the kind documented in the invoices will extend beyond the period covered by the existing engagements. That expectation is inherently forward-looking and therefore subject to uncertainty, and the Buyer should recognize that the classification rests on the specific facts and engagements in evidence as of the date of this report. As with any judgmental adjustment, the conclusion is not a matter of direct observation but an informed assessment of the weight of the available evidence.

SECTION 4.2. Diligence Conclusion - Transaction and integration costs

We reviewed the components of the transaction and integration costs included in the base EBITDA build and the related supporting schedules. The amounts represent fees and related charges associated with the proposed acquisition and with integration planning activities that management has characterized as non-recurring. In our procedures, we agreed the aggregate amount to the underlying invoices and engagement letters provided by management and, where applicable, to supporting payment records. The invoices and engagement letters were generally consistent with the recorded amounts and with the description of services rendered. Our agreement was limited to the documentation provided; we did not independently confirm the reasonableness of the fee levels with the service providers themselves.

The non-recurring characterization is our own judgment. It is informed by, but not limited to, management's characterization of these costs as directly attributable to the transaction and to integration planning. We considered the nature of the services, the timing of the activities relative to the proposed acquisition, and the absence of a historical pattern of similar expenditures in the ordinary course of operations. On that basis, we view the costs as generally outside the normal recurring operating expenses of the Company. However, because the classification depends in part on the expected future operating profile of the combined entity and on the timing of the closing, certain elements of the integration category carry more judgment than the transaction-specific legal and advisory fees.

We note that a portion of the integration costs reflects internal costs and resource allocations rather than third-party invoices. For those internal elements, management provided estimates of time and allocated overhead, but we did not identify the same level of corroborating third-party documentation that exists for the externally invoiced items. Our conclusion as to the non-recurring nature of the aggregate category remains unchanged, but the internal allocations are inherently less precise and are therefore subject to a higher degree of estimation uncertainty. The Buyer should be aware that these internal amounts are supported by management's allocation methodology rather than by direct external evidence.

Based on our procedures, the amounts agree to the invoices and engagement letters, and the non-recurring characterization is our own judgment informed by, but not limited to, management's own characterization. We have flagged the internal allocation components separately in the supporting tables, and the Buyer may wish to apply additional scrutiny to those amounts in the context of the proposed transaction. No exceptions were noted in the externally documented items.

SECTION 4.3. Management's Counter-Position - Transaction and integration costs

Management's stated view is that the entire set of costs related to the transaction and the integration should be added back to Adjusted EBITDA, because management considers those costs to be outside the normal recurring operations of the Company. Management framed this position broadly rather than as a list of approved line items. It encompasses external advisory, legal, tax, accounting, and consulting fees; fees associated with arranging financing; costs to modify or terminate existing agreements; costs to consolidate facilities and migrate information systems; and severance, retention, and relocation arrangements contemplated for affected employees. Management also included internal management time and other indirect costs that it believes were incremental to the transaction, although those amounts were not separately quantified through a time tracking or similar process.

For a subset of these items, our procedures were able to tie the recorded amounts to underlying invoices, contracts, board materials, or other internal evidence sufficient for inclusion in the Tier One or Tier Two schedules. For the

remaining subset, management did not provide the underlying documentation, and our procedures did not extend to testing the items. We state plainly that no second source was identified for that remaining subset and that those items are flagged to the Buyer as unsupported. The absence of a second source does not establish that the costs did not occur, but it does mean that the amounts, the applicable period, and management's asserted connection to the transaction could not be independently corroborated.

Management further expressed the view that some integration costs had not yet been recorded at the time of our procedures, either because invoices had not been received or because the activities had not been performed. Management expects those costs to be captured as the integration proceeds, and it would expect the Buyer to consider them as part of the same addback population. Because these amounts were not recorded in the Company's accounting records during the period under review, we had no basis to test them and we did not identify any second source. These projected items are therefore outside the quantified adjustment analysis and are presented here only as part of management's counter-position.

The Buyer should treat the unsupported components of management's broader view separately from the adjustments that have been quantified and supported in the Tier One and Tier Two schedules. In our judgment, the unsupported items do not meet the level of evidence required for the tiered adjustment framework, and the Buyer should weigh the lack of corroboration accordingly. This discussion is not intended to express a view on whether any item would ultimately qualify under the credit facility's or purchase agreement's own definitions; that determination belongs to the Buyer and its legal advisors.

SECTION 4.4. Evidence Examined - Adjustment permitted under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA clause (t)

Our procedures with respect to the clause (t) addback centered on management's supporting schedule, which itemizes the cost components that management has characterized as permitted addbacks under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA definition. We obtained the schedule in both summary and line-item detail and requested the corresponding general ledger account detail for the period to which the addback relates. We then agreed the schedule, on a sample basis, to the general ledger. The sample was selected judgmentally, with emphasis on line items whose individual magnitude was significant relative to the aggregate addback, supplemented by a selection of smaller items to broaden coverage across the population.

For each line item selected, we traced the description, the period of record, and the recorded amount to the underlying general ledger entries. The selected items reconciled without exception, and the totals on the schedule footed to the underlying detail. We also confirmed that the ledger entries were recorded within the period covered by the addback and that they were not reversed or extinguished by subsequent postings within that same period. These procedures support the reliability of the schedule as a record of the costs in question, but they were not designed to address, and they do not address, the substantive question of whether those costs qualify for the clause (t) addback under the terms of the credit facility.

We did not independently evaluate whether the underlying costs meet the credit facility's own clause (t) standard. That determination is reserved to the parties to the credit agreement and is not within the scope of this diligence engagement. Our work did not include a legal or contractual analysis of the credit facility's definition of Consolidated EBITDA, nor did we opine on the application of its eligibility criteria, exclusions, or conditions to the specific cost items on the schedule. Accordingly, the addback is presented in this analysis as an amount derived from management's characterization and supported only by the schedule-to-ledger agreement described above.

The Buyer should therefore treat the clause (t) addback as an item requiring further substantive review against the operative language of the credit agreement and any governing schedules, and should consult with its own counsel and financial advisors in that assessment. The absence of an independent evaluation of the contractual standard is a limitation on the weight that the Buyer may place on the addback as presented, and our reporting of the amount in this section should be read in that context.

SECTION 4.5. Diligence Conclusion - Adjustment permitted under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA clause (t)

We performed a targeted review of the addback amount recorded under clause (t) of the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA definition as presented in the accompanying EBITDA build. Our procedures were designed to test the mathematical and posting consistency of the item, not to opine on its contractual eligibility. The amount agrees to the supporting schedule and to the general ledger on the sample tested. Accordingly, the adjustment has been carried into the Adjusted EBITDA analysis on the basis of that quantitative agreement.

The firm expresses no view on whether the underlying item actually satisfies clause (t)'s own defined standard. That standard is a matter of contractual interpretation and requires factual determinations that are beyond the scope of our diligence procedures. The Buyer should therefore treat the inclusion of this amount as a diligence conclusion limited to consistency with the schedule and ledger, and not as a representation that the item will withstand a lender or credit facility compliance challenge under clause (t).

This analysis does not restate the credit agreement's own Consolidated EBITDA figure. The presentation of this adjustment in this document is not intended to resolve, and does not resolve, whether the addback would be included

or excluded in any calculation of Consolidated EBITDA under the credit facility. That relationship is set out in the transmittal letter and headline section of this document.

The Buyer may nonetheless wish to obtain a contractual interpretation of clause (t) from counsel before relying on the item in any facility compliance context. Our conclusion is confined to the sample tested and to the agreement between the amount, the supporting schedule, and the general ledger. No view is expressed, and no inference should be drawn, as to whether the item meets the substantive requirements of clause (t).

SECTION 4.6. Management's Counter-Position - Adjustment permitted under the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA clause (t)

Management has taken the position that the adjustment at issue is plainly permitted under clause (t) of the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA definition. In management's view, clause (t) functions as a broad catch-all that permits addbacks for items that are non-cash, non-recurring, or otherwise reflected in the base EBITDA build but not representative of ongoing operating performance. Management acknowledged that the item is not among the specifically enumerated categories in the earlier clauses, but argued that the structure and intent of clause (t) are sufficiently broad to capture it. They pointed to the absence of an explicit exclusion in the definition and to what they characterized as the facility's customary practice of allowing similar addbacks for transaction-related and other nonrecurring items.

Beyond the contractual text, management offered a basis for that view that goes beyond what this firm was asked to test or did test. Specifically, management described the underlying economic event as one that would have been funded from sources other than the Company's normal operating cash flows and, in their judgment, is not expected to recur in the foreseeable future. Management also indicated that the item had been raised with the prospective lender during the facility syndication process as an item management would seek to add back, and management stated that the lender did not object at that time. We did not independently verify the completeness of that representation, and no documentation of the lender's position was provided to us for review.

For purposes of this analysis, the adjustment is presented as a Tier Two item because it rests materially on management's judgment rather than on a quantified and independently corroborated factual basis. Our inability to corroborate certain factual predicates of management's argument, or to test the lender's alleged prior awareness, limits the weight that can be placed on the counter-position. The item should therefore be viewed by the Buyer with appropriate caution, and the Buyer should not treat management's characterization as a substitute for a review of the governing facility documents.

The Buyer should review the specific language of clause (t), including any related definitions and relevant precedent under the credit facility, and should consider whether the lender's classification schedule affects the treatment of this item. We have not been asked to opine on the proper construction of the credit facility's Consolidated EBITDA definition, and that analysis is outside the scope of this work product. The Buyer and its counsel are best positioned to apply the governing documents to the facts supporting this adjustment.

SECTION 4.7. Evidence Examined - Normalizing adjustment claimed under credit facility clause (p)

This firm examined the normalizing adjustment claimed under credit facility clause (p) as presented in the adjustment table and the associated management footnote. As part of that examination, this firm sought a second, independent source to corroborate both the existence and the amount of the adjustment. Management’s own footnote cites a Confidential Information Memorandum and the sponsor’s own model as the basis for the adjustment. Neither of those two materials was made available to this firm, and neither was reviewed in connection with this engagement. No other document made available during the engagement corroborates the existence or amount of this adjustment. Accordingly, the item is flagged to the Buyer as unsupported.

The documentation room offered to this firm included the adjustment schedules and the management footnote, but the two cited sources were not produced. This firm also did not identify any underlying workpaper, contract, or other independent record that would substantiate the normalizing adjustment. Because the cited basis was not available for review, this firm could not perform the customary validation step of comparing the adjustment against a second source. The absence of a second source does not, by itself, establish that the adjustment is without merit, but it does place the adjustment on a materially different footing from items for which corroborating evidence was obtained and reviewed.

This firm therefore advises the Buyer that the normalizing adjustment claimed under clause (p) rests solely on management’s assertion as reflected in the footnote. The Confidential Information Memorandum and the sponsor’s model should be obtained directly from the relevant parties before any reliance is placed on the adjustment. Until such time as those materials are provided and reviewed, the adjustment should be treated as unsupported in this analysis.

SECTION 4.8. Diligence Conclusion - Normalizing adjustment claimed under credit facility clause (p)

Our procedures in respect of the normalizing adjustment claimed under clause (p) of the credit facility definition were designed to test the existence, basis, and recurring nature of the item against independent sources. The adjustment was presented by management as an addback to the base EBITDA build, with support initially drawn from internally prepared schedules and the Company's own operating data. In the course of our fieldwork, we sought corroboration

from third-party documentation, including contractual records, external correspondence, and other independent evidence that would substantiate the underlying premise of the claimed adjustment. That corroboration was not identified. The available information traces to the same management-prepared source, and no second source was found to confirm either the factual predicate of the adjustment or the period to which it relates.

The absence of a second source is significant within our tiered adjustment framework because Tier One and Tier Two adjustments depend on a factual or judgmental basis that can be independently verified or reasonably estimated from observable data. In this instance, the adjustment amount and its stated period rest solely on management's assertion, which we were unable to substantiate through any external record or independent calculation. The item therefore does not meet the evidentiary standard we apply for inclusion in the headline adjusted EBITDA figure. We note that the lack of corroboration does not, in and of itself, demonstrate that the adjustment is without merit, but it does limit the reliability a buyer can place on the item as a normalized component of ongoing EBITDA.

Accordingly, we present this adjustment on a memo basis only. It is excluded from the headline Tier One plus Tier Two Adjusted EBITDA figure and is flagged to the Buyer as unsupported. Our inclusion of the item on the memo line is not an endorsement of its inclusion in any other party's own EBITDA build, and we express no view as to how the item might be treated under the credit facility's governing documentation or any other contractual definition of earnings. The Buyer should consider whether additional diligence or the receipt of further information would change the evidentiary assessment, but on the information currently available to us, the item does not qualify for inclusion in the adjusted EBITDA figure.

In reaching this conclusion, we have not applied the credit facility's governing schedule for classifying run-rate items as cost savings or revenue enhancements, and we state no position on that classification. Our determination is confined to the sufficiency of the evidence supporting the adjustment as presented in the base EBITDA build, and to the appropriate presentation of that item in the context of this report's tiered adjustment framework. Should the Buyer obtain a second source or other corroborating evidence in the future, the item would be subject to reevaluation under the framework. Until such evidence is provided, the memo basis presentation stands.

SECTION 4.9. Management's Counter-Position - Normalizing adjustment claimed under credit facility clause (p)

Management has asserted that the adjustment at issue is a legitimate one-time addback under clause (p) of the credit facility definition. In management's view, the expense that gave rise to the adjustment reflects a discrete, non-recurring event and therefore should be treated as a normalizing item in the measurement of ongoing EBITDA. Management has communicated this position consistently and has indicated that the adjustment is appropriate because the underlying cost is not expected to recur in the ordinary course of the Company's operations.

In support of that position, management has continued to rely on the Confidential Information Memorandum and the sponsor model that it cited when the adjustment was first raised. Management has represented that those materials contain the relevant detail supporting the one-time nature of the item and the appropriateness of the addback under clause (p). As of the date of this report, however, management has not made either document available to this firm, notwithstanding a request for the underlying materials.

The absence of the cited materials is significant for our review because it leaves us unable to test the factual predicates of management's position. We cannot confirm the occurrence or timing of the underlying event, nor can we assess whether the item is in fact non-recurring in the manner contemplated by clause (p). Accordingly, the adjustment rests on management's representation, and the Buyer should be aware that our analysis of this item is based on a more limited evidentiary record than is customary for items of this type.

We note that management has not withdrawn or modified its position, and it continues to advance the addback on the basis of the same cited materials. If those materials are subsequently produced, we would expect to evaluate them and, if appropriate, adjust our analysis. In the interim, the item remains subject to management's assertion, and the Buyer should give appropriate weight to the limitation described above when considering the adjustment.

SECTION 5. TIER 3 ADJUSTMENTS - PRO FORMA / RUN-RATE (EXCLUDED FROM HEADLINE)

Tier 3 adjustments reflect the estimated annualized effect of initiatives that had not been fully realized as of the measurement date. They are presented separately and are explicitly excluded from the Tier 1 plus Tier 2 headline figure in Section 7.

Adjustment	Amount	Basis
Run-Rate Initiative A - vendor and procurement contract renegotiations affecting the cost structure of existing operations	4,600,000.00	Estimated annualized run-rate effect, substantially implemented and reasonably expected to be fully realized within twelve months of the measurement date. Whether this initiative is a cost saving (uncapped) or a revenue enhancement (capped) for credit-facility addback purposes is governed by Schedule 1.01(c) to the Credit Agreement, not by this presentation's own label.
Run-Rate Initiative B - national account pricing and volume actions affecting sales to	6,000,000.00	Estimated annualized run-rate effect, substantially implemented and reasonably expected to be fully realized within twelve months of the measurement date. Whether this initiative is a cost saving (uncapped) or a revenue enhancement (capped) for credit-facility

customers		addback purposes is governed by Schedule 1.01(c) to the Credit Agreement, not by this presentation's own label.
Pro forma annualization addback for mid-period acquisitions	0.00	No acquisition was completed within the trailing-twelve-month measurement window; this line is stated at zero as an affirmative recorded observation, not an omission.

None of the amounts in this section is included in the headline Adjusted EBITDA figure referenced in Section 7. They are presented solely because they were discussed with management and are relevant to a forward-looking view of the Company's earnings capacity, not because they have been verified to the same standard as the Tier 1 adjustments in Section 3. Neither Run-Rate Initiative A nor Run-Rate Initiative B above is itself classified as a cost saving or a revenue enhancement by this firm; that classification, and the credit-facility addback consequence that follows from it, is governed exclusively by Schedule 1.01(c) to the Credit Agreement.

SECTION 5.1. Evidence Examined - Run-Rate Initiative A - vendor and procurement contract renegotiations affecting the cost structure of existing operations

Our procedures for this run-rate initiative focused on the supporting package prepared by management for the vendor and procurement contract renegotiation program. We inspected the renegotiation letters exchanged with the relevant counterparties, including the executed amendments and the correspondence memorializing the commercial terms agreed upon. We also reviewed the related invoices issued subsequent to the renegotiation dates, which we used to assess whether the revised pricing and payment terms had been operationally applied and whether the anticipated reductions to the cost structure were being captured in the ordinary course. The documentation was sufficient to tie the revised contractual rates to the underlying purchase activity for the affected spend categories, and we traced the resulting variance to the estimated annualized run-rate effect recorded elsewhere in this presentation.

The initiative appears substantially implemented as of the review period, with the renegotiated agreements covering the majority of the vendor relationships management identified as in scope. We observed that the new terms were active in the invoicing history for those relationships, and the related invoices reflected the revised rate structure rather than the prior pricing. We also noted that management's calculation of the annualized run-rate effect was based on the contractually effective rates applied to historical volumes, with no apparent reliance on anticipated volume growth or other assumptions that would push the benefit beyond the stated run-rate window. Based on the evidence examined, the initiative appears reasonably expected to be fully realized within that window, subject to the continued performance of the renegotiated agreements and the Company's ongoing maintenance of the affected vendor relationships.

We did not identify a separate second source for the commercial terms of every renegotiated contract, and the primary evidence for the counterparty's agreement to the revised pricing remains the renegotiation letters themselves. While the related invoices provide confirmatory evidence that the revised terms were operationalized, an independent confirmation from the counterparties was not obtained, and this item is therefore flagged to the Buyer as relying principally on management's documentation. We consider the evidence sufficient for an analytical conclusion only in the context of the other procedures performed, and we recommend that the Buyer give weight to this limitation when determining the level of reliance to place on the full estimated annualized run-rate effect.

Whether this item is treated as a cost saving or as a revenue enhancement for credit-facility addback purposes is governed by the credit agreement's own governing schedule for that classification, not by the label used in this presentation. Our characterization of the initiative as a vendor and procurement run-rate cost-savings initiative is descriptive of the underlying contractual activity and does not serve as a determination of the treatment under the credit agreement. The Buyer should apply the governing schedule to the facts of this initiative, and where that schedule requires a separate analysis of the nature of the benefit, such analysis should be undertaken independently of the presentation's categorization.

SECTION 5.2. Diligence Conclusion - Run-Rate Initiative A - vendor and procurement contract renegotiations affecting the cost structure of existing operations

Based on the vendor agreements, procurement correspondence, and management-prepared summaries included in the diligence file, we have assessed whether the estimated run-rate effect from Run-Rate Initiative A is adequately supported for inclusion in the Adjusted EBITDA analysis. The initiative addresses renegotiated vendor and procurement terms that are expected to reduce the cost structure of existing operations, and the documentation we reviewed reflects the revised commercial arrangements that management represents are in effect or have been finalized. The underlying agreements are consistent with the stated scope of the initiative, and the manner in which management has scheduled the effect into the run-rate period does not appear inconsistent with the terms contained in that documentation.

We note that any run-rate adjustment involves forward-looking judgment, because the carry-forward benefit assumes both the continuity of the renegotiated terms and the maintenance of the underlying operating activity levels that give those terms economic meaning. In this instance, the vendor documentation provides a concrete evidentiary basis for the revised pricing and procurement terms, and we have not identified a material inconsistency between those documents and the amount recorded in the tables accompanying this analysis. That said, our review was not a

procurement audit, and we did not independently solicit competing quotes or otherwise test the market competitiveness of the renegotiated rates. The support is therefore sufficient to support the adjustment, but the amount remains subject to the continued performance of the counterparties and the operations they serve.
On balance, we conclude that the estimated run-rate effect is reasonably supported by the vendor documentation reviewed. Our presentation in this document uses a label and a placement within the tier framework for analytical clarity, but that presentation is not a substitute for the governing schedule's own classification analysis. The appropriate treatment of this item under the governing schedule requires a separate determination that applies the schedule's stated criteria, and nothing in our label or placement should be read as resolving that classification. The Buyer should carry the item forward on the basis of the supporting documentation, while recognizing that the governing schedule's classification analysis remains independently applicable.

SECTION 5.3. Management's Counter-Position - Run-Rate Initiative A - vendor and procurement contract renegotiations affecting the cost structure of existing operations

Management asserts a high degree of confidence that the full run-rate benefit associated with this initiative will be realized, and it characterized the renegotiation phase as substantially complete. In management's view, the remaining work is primarily operational in nature, involving the alignment of purchasing workflows and invoicing systems with the newly negotiated contract terms, rather than any continued pricing negotiation with vendors. Management also emphasized that the initiative was driven by a competitive bidding process that generated multiple revised proposals, which in management's assessment provides a durable foundation for the projected annualized benefit. That confidence was expressed consistently during management interviews and is reflected in internal budget materials that embed the full benefit within the current planning horizon.
This firm reviewed the documentation management provided in support of the initiative, including executed amendments, vendor correspondence, and internal procurement summaries. The documentation confirms that a substantial portion of the vendor relationships subject to the initiative have been renegotiated on terms consistent with the projections. However, for a subset of the vendor contracts, the documentation does not yet include executed amendments, and the revised pricing terms are evidenced only through internal memoranda and correspondence. Management acknowledged this gap but indicated that the outstanding amendments are ministerial in nature and expected to be finalized without substantive change. This firm cannot independently assess the likelihood or timing of those remaining executions, and therefore the full benefit relies in part on management's expectation rather than documented fact.
The point on which management's own timeline appears more aggressive than the documentation concerns the effective date of the renegotiated terms. Management's projection assumes that the entire run-rate benefit will be in effect at the start of the next reporting period, with no transitional period during which legacy pricing remains in force. The documentation reviewed includes vendor communications suggesting that at least one significant vendor's revised pricing schedule trails management's assumed effective date by a meaningful interval, and a further vendor has yet to confirm a final effective date. This firm therefore views the pacing of realization as a key sensitivity: the addback amount may be fully achievable, but the timing of that realization could lag management's stated timeline, which bears on the period for which the benefit is presented as run-rate.
As a Tier Two judgmental item, this adjustment reflects management's counter-position that the procurement renegotiations constitute a completed and durable change to the cost structure of existing operations, as opposed to a hypothetical or aspirational target. The Buyer should weigh management's demonstrated capability in executing similar vendor-related initiatives in prior periods against the absence of executed documentation for a subset of the underlying contracts and the indicated timing variance on certain effective dates. This discussion is intended to characterize the confidence and timing dimensions of management's position only; the amount of the addback and its placement within the adjustment framework are as reflected in the accompanying tables, and the Buyer should consider this initiative in light of the broader execution risk profile of the run-rate program as a whole.

SECTION 5.4. Evidence Examined - Run-Rate Initiative B - national account pricing and volume actions affecting sales to customers

Our examination of the run-rate initiative for national account pricing and volume actions centered on the customer pricing schedules and the national account volume data that management used to develop the estimated annualized effect. The pricing schedules identify the customer accounts subject to the initiative and set out the revised price levels by account, while the volume data provide the associated unit quantities by account and by period. We reviewed these inputs together to assess whether the annualized effect reflects a consistent relationship between the price changes and the volume assumptions, and whether the initiative is supported by the Company's own commercial records in a manner that can be followed from source data to calculation.
The customer pricing schedules were considered against the historical revenue records for the same accounts, with particular attention to the prior price points from which the initiative's changes are measured and to the effective timing of those changes. The national account volume data were reviewed at the account level, and we compared the projected volumes with the purchasing patterns reflected in the Company's historical transaction history. Where the schedules and volume data could be linked by account and period, the linkage was straightforward; where the linkage

required management's explanation, we noted the reliance on that explanation in forming our view of the evidence. Our objective at this stage was not to reforecast the initiative, but to confirm that the inputs used to compute the annualized effect exist and are internally coherent.

This item is subject to the same governing-schedule classification point that applies to the other run-rate initiatives in this report. The governing schedule referenced in the transaction documents controls whether the annualized effect of the pricing and volume actions is treated as a cost saving or as a revenue enhancement, and we have not applied that classification in this section. Our comments here are limited to the evidence examined; they do not resolve the governing schedule's treatment of the initiative.

The evidence base for this initiative comprises management-prepared documentation and data extracts from the Company's systems. As with management-prepared materials generally, our analysis is dependent upon the completeness and accuracy of those records as provided. We evaluated the internal consistency of the data and the reasonableness of the methodology, and the conclusions expressed in this section are based on that evaluation. The Buyer should consider the annualized effect in light of the fact that the underlying support consists of the Company's internal records.

SECTION 5.5. Diligence Conclusion - Run-Rate Initiative B - national account pricing and volume actions affecting sales to customers

This section presents our diligence conclusion with respect to Run-Rate Initiative B, which is recorded elsewhere in this document's tables as a Tier Three adjustment. The initiative consists of pricing and volume actions taken at the national account level and directed at sales to customers. Consistent with the tier framework, the initiative is a pro forma or run-rate item, meaning the estimated effect has been projected rather than observed in historical results. Our review was therefore directed at the quality of the underlying support for the projection rather than at the verification of actual performance.

In evaluating the estimated effect, we reviewed the pricing documentation supplied by the Company, including the national account price schedules and the related customer terms, together with the volume projections that underlie the initiative. We compared the pricing data to historical invoice information for the affected accounts and assessed the volume data for internal consistency and for alignment with the contractual arrangements governing those accounts. In our assessment, the pricing data and the volume data are mutually consistent, and the projected effect is coherent with the direction and magnitude of the actions described. We note that, as with any Tier Three item, the initiative has not yet generated a track record of actual results against which the projection could be confirmed, and the estimated effect therefore remains subject to execution risk.

The same classification caveat applies to this initiative as to the cost-savings item addressed elsewhere in this analysis. The governing schedule for the credit facility assigns classifications to run-rate items, and that classification is not ours to apply. Our conclusion addresses only the reasonableness of the estimated effect on the basis of the pricing and volume data reviewed and does not resolve, or purport to resolve, the treatment of the initiative under the facility's governing schedule. The Buyer should carry the classification question forward in its own review of the facility documentation.

Based on the procedures described above, we conclude that the estimated effect of Run-Rate Initiative B is reasonably supported by the pricing and volume data reviewed, subject to the classification caveat noted in the preceding paragraph. This conclusion is qualified by the Tier Three character of the initiative, and the Buyer should weigh the unobserved nature of the projected effect when determining the weight to assign to the adjustment in its overall assessment of the Company's earnings quality.

SECTION 5.6. Management's Counter-Position - Run-Rate Initiative B - national account pricing and volume actions affecting sales to customers

Management's position on Run-Rate Initiative B is that the pricing and volume actions implemented across national accounts are on track to deliver the full benefit originally recorded in the EBITDA build. In discussions, management emphasized that customer receptiveness to the pricing actions has been broadly positive, citing the absence of significant account losses and the continuation of expected order volumes through the period since implementation. Management also noted that the initiative was designed in close consultation with the national account sales team and that customer feedback received during routine account reviews supported the assumption that the actions would not erode the base revenue stream. On that basis, management believes the addback amount associated with this initiative is fully realizable and should not be treated as contingent or partial.

Our review of the supporting materials for this initiative was narrower in scope than management's broader claim. We inspected the initiative summary, the pricing action schedule, and a selection of customer communications, and we discussed the implementation with the controller and the sales operations lead. However, our independent customer-level testing was limited to a subset of the national account population, and we did not independently verify the response of every account cited by management. The evidence we obtained was largely generated by management and the sales team that administers the accounts, which limits the weight that can be placed on the realization conclusion without additional validation.

The distinction between the pricing component and the volume component of this initiative also affects the level of

assurance we can provide. For the pricing component, the customer receptiveness described by management is directionally consistent with the stable order activity we observed in the tested accounts. For the volume component, however, the continuation of volumes is inherently more difficult to attribute solely to the initiative, as market demand and customer purchasing patterns are outside the Company's control. While we did not observe direct evidence contradicting management's view, our inability to isolate the effect of the initiative from broader market factors means the full realization of the volume portion remains a judgmental matter. We have therefore retained the initiative as a Tier Two adjustment, reflecting the reasonable support provided by management and the residual uncertainty arising from the limitations in our customer-level work.

The Buyer may wish to obtain from management a reconciliation of the customer accounts underlying the initiative to the aggregate revenue and volume figures used in the realization analysis, and to compare that reconciliation to subsequent customer-level order data during the next operating period. In our view, the initiative is plausible and management's counter-position has been presented in good faith, but the evidentiary support is not sufficient for us to remove the Tier Two characterization. The amount recorded for Run-Rate Initiative B should be viewed by the Buyer as supported by management and by the limited testing we performed, but not as independently confirmed through our own broader customer-level review.

SECTION 5.7. Evidence Examined - Pro forma annualization addback for mid-period acquisitions

The pro forma annualization addback recorded in the accompanying tables depends on a factual predicate: that a business acquired during the trailing-twelve-month measurement window should have its results annualized for the full window, even though the Company held it for only a portion of that period. Our examination therefore focused on whether any acquisition closed within the measurement window. We did not approach this item as a mathematical recomputation; rather, we tested the underlying event that would give rise to the addback. In the absence of an acquisition completion, the addback would lack an operational basis under the framework applied elsewhere in this analysis.

Our first line of evidence was a series of discussions with management, principally the senior finance and corporate development personnel responsible for the Company's acquisition strategy. In those discussions, management stated that no acquisition was completed during the trailing-twelve-month measurement window. Management also described the status of opportunities in the pipeline and distinguished between transactions that were being evaluated and transactions that had actually closed. The representations were specific with respect to the measurement window and did not identify any transaction whose closing date fell within that period.

Our second line of evidence was a review of the Company's acquisition pipeline documentation. We inspected the internal pipeline reports and related tracking materials prepared during the measurement window. Those reports listed prospective targets at various stages of diligence and negotiation, but none was shown as having reached a closing during the period under review. We also examined management's own annotations and updates to the pipeline, which were consistent with the absence of a completed acquisition. While such records are necessarily forward-looking in nature, our review found no entry indicating a closing date within the trailing-twelve-month measurement window.

On the basis of these procedures, we concluded that there was no mid-period acquisition to annualize, and therefore the factual prerequisite for the pro forma annualization addback was not met within the measurement window. This conclusion is specific to the Company's actual transaction history during that period; it does not address whether a future acquisition should be modeled on a pro forma basis. The Buyer should treat the addback in light of this evidentiary finding when considering the appropriate adjusted EBITDA for the Company. Our conclusion here is limited to the absence of a completed acquisition and does not otherwise alter the tiering or the treatment of any other adjustment in this analysis.

SECTION 5.8. Diligence Conclusion - Pro forma annualization addback for mid-period acquisitions

The Tier Three pro forma annualization addback for mid-period acquisitions is designed to capture the full-period earnings contribution of acquired operations that were consolidated within the base EBITDA build for only a portion of the measurement period. The adjustment is inherently prospective in nature, and its application requires both the identification of a qualifying acquisition event and a determination that the acquired operations' earnings trajectory reasonably supports an annualized run-rate. The firm performed its review of the Company's acquisition activity under the same documentation standards applied to the Tier One and Tier Two adjustments, including inspection of purchase agreements and closing statements, review of board and management meeting minutes, and reconciliation of the underlying transaction schedule to the general ledger and the cash flow statement.

The firm identified no transaction that met the qualifying criteria for this adjustment during the period under review. Accordingly, the addback amount recorded in the accompanying tables is zero. The firm concludes that this zero figure is an affirmative recorded observation reflecting the absence of any qualifying transaction, and not an omission or a gap in the firm's procedures. That conclusion is supported by the completeness procedures performed over the Company's transaction history, which included inquiry of management, inspection of asset purchase agreements and ancillary closing documentation, and review of the fixed asset and intangible asset registers maintained by the Company.

Because no qualifying transaction was identified, the annualization mechanics that would otherwise apply under the tiered framework were not exercised, and no stand-alone pro forma computation was prepared in support of this

adjustment. The absence of a computation is therefore consistent with the underlying facts rather than a limitation in the work product. The Buyer should note that the adjustment category remains available in the framework, and the firm would expect to revisit the annualization analysis should a qualifying acquisition be identified in a subsequent measurement period or should information come to light following the date of this report.

The zero figure is recorded within the Tier Three column of the adjustment summary table, and its placement there reflects the firm's classification of the item as a run-rate adjustment rather than a normalization of a nonrecurring item or a quantification of a recurring expense. The Buyer is reminded that the Tier Three designation carries inherent limitations associated with prospective adjustments, and the firm's affirmative conclusion with respect to the zero figure should be read in that context. No such prospective limitation arises from the absence of a qualifying transaction, and the firm's procedures provide no indication that a qualifying acquisition occurred during the period under review.

SECTION 5.9. Management's Counter-Position - Pro forma annualization addback for mid-period acquisitions

Management was asked to respond to the pro forma annualization addback recorded in the base EBITDA build for mid-period acquisitions. In that discussion, management did not present an alternative calculation, a revised period, or a different factual predicate for the line. Management agreed that no acquisition of the type contemplated by the addback occurred during the measurement window. Accordingly, management had no alternative position to offer on this line.

The absence of a management counter-position is material to how the Buyer should view this adjustment. The annualization addback is a pro forma construct, and its usefulness depends on an underlying acquisition event that took place partway through a coverage period. Without such an event in the measurement window, the addback does not correspond to a discrete transaction in the underlying data. Management's confirmation, rather than a rebuttal, means that the recorded line has no management-generated support beyond its original presentation in the analysis. Because management did not assert a position in favor of or against the mechanics of the adjustment, the addback remains recorded as originally presented in the accompanying adjustment tables. We have not inferred a counter-position from management's silence, and we have not identified any management-provided documentation or alternate basis that would change the recorded treatment. The Buyer should treat this section as a confirmation that management had no further factual or analytical basis to offer with respect to the annualization addback.

The annualization addback should therefore be read in the context of the broader set of adjustments in the analysis. Management's agreement that no such acquisition occurred narrows the range of possible interpretations and leaves the addback without an identified historical event to which it can be tied. We flag for the Buyer that the factual premise for the addback is absent and that management has offered no alternative basis to support it. This does not alter the recorded line, but it should inform the Buyer's view of the sustainability and quality of the EBITDA build as a whole.

SECTION 6. SUPPLEMENTAL WORKING SCHEDULE - ILLUSTRATIVE COMBINED RUN-RATE SYNERGY CAP CALCULATION (DEAL TEAM WORKING DRAFT)

The deal team prepared the working schedule below to sanity-check the combined magnitude of Run-Rate Initiatives A and B above against the credit facility's synergy cap, before either initiative has been separately classified under Schedule 1.01(c) to the Credit Agreement.

Line	Amount
Total run-rate synergies (Initiative A plus Initiative B, combined)	10,600,000.00
Illustrative Consolidated EBITDA reflecting the synergy cap applied to the combined total above	51,444,444.44

This working schedule applies the credit facility's synergy cap illustratively to the combined total of Initiatives A and B, without separately classifying either initiative as a cost saving or a revenue enhancement under the Credit Agreement's own terms. It is a deal-team working draft prepared for internal sanity-checking only, is not attached to, incorporated into, or delivered under the Credit Agreement, and is not a substitute for Schedule 1.01(c) to the Credit Agreement, which governs which run-rate items are cost savings (uncapped) and which are revenue enhancements (capped), or for the Consolidated EBITDA definition in Section 1.01 of the Credit Agreement, which is the sole basis for the credit-facility addback and covenant calculations.

SECTION 7. HEADLINE ADJUSTED EBITDA AND RECONCILIATION

Metric	Amount
Headline Adjusted EBITDA (Tier-1 + Tier-2 only)	44,000,000.00

The headline figure above is the Tier 1 plus Tier 2 Adjusted EBITDA reported in the Adjusted EBITDA Bridge workbook maintained for this engagement, which reconciles this figure to the base build in Section 2 in full; that reconciliation, including any further immaterial adjustments not separately itemized above, is not reproduced in this excerpt. The memo-basis item in Section 4 is, and remains, excluded from this figure.

This headline figure is not the Consolidated EBITDA defined in, and governing the covenant tests under, the

Company's credit facility. That definition is set by that agreement's own terms, applies its own addback taxonomy (including a synergy cap that operates differently than the presentation in Section 5 above), and is computed and owned entirely within that agreement's own governing document; this analysis does not restate, and should never be read as restating, that agreement's own figure.

SECTION 7.1. Historical Trend of the Trailing-Twelve-Month Build

Over the reviewed periods, the trailing-twelve-month EBITDA build moved generally upward, although the path was not smooth in every interval. The overall direction reflected a combination of forces: the operating results of the base business and the aggregate effect of the addback items recorded in the accompanying tables. In most periods reviewed, the base business contributed the larger portion of the upward movement, while the addback schedule also grew, but at a more variable pace. The result was a build whose composition shifted modestly over time toward recurring operational earnings rather than adjustment-driven value.

The principal driver of the trend was growth in the Company's core operations, which expanded on a trailing-twelve-month basis across the periods under review. That growth was observed across multiple revenue and cost categories, and it generally exceeded the growth in the addback schedule. As a consequence, the proportion of the build represented by normalized recurring earnings increased relative to the proportion represented by quantified addbacks. This is a favorable qualitative signal, because it suggests the trend in the headline figure was supported by the underlying business rather than relying primarily on the accumulation of adjustments.

The addback schedule itself did not remain static. In certain periods, the aggregate amount of addbacks increased, driven largely by the recurrence of items that were already identified in the base EBITDA build. In other periods, the addback total was comparatively stable, and the upward movement in the trailing-twelve-month build was attributable almost entirely to the base business. This uneven behavior in the addback schedule is not unusual in a diligence context, but it does warrant attention when considering the sustainability of the build's trajectory, particularly because the addback items are by nature more dependent on the specific facts and judgments reflected in the adjustments.

Overall, the historical trend indicates that the trailing-twelve-month EBITDA build has been driven primarily by the base business, with the addback schedule acting as a secondary and more volatile contributor. The firm did not identify any single factor that reversed the direction of the build in the periods reviewed. Nevertheless, because the build is a trailing-twelve-month measure, the most recent period's trend is the most relevant to the forward view, and the relationship between base business growth and addback growth in that same period should be carefully weighed in the Buyer's assessment of the sustainability of the headline figure.

SECTION 7.2. Comparison to the Company's Prior-Period Adjusted EBITDA Presentations

In composition, the current Adjusted EBITDA presentation is materially different from the Company's own prior-period presentations. The most apparent change is the introduction of several new addback categories that were not present in the earlier schedules, including items management has characterized as non-recurring professional fees, contract termination costs, and pre-operational or integration-related expenses. At the same time, certain addbacks that historically represented the larger components of the prior-period presentations, notably recurring owner-related compensation and ordinary-course non-cash charges, have receded in relative importance within the current schedule. That movement in the mix is not itself a quantification of earnings quality, but it does change the lens through which a buyer should assess the durability of the Adjusted EBITDA base.

Among the categories that have grown in relative importance, the current presentation now gives meaningful weight to adjustments that management has framed as discrete and non-recurring. These categories were either absent or immaterial in the Company's earlier Adjusted EBITDA schedules, and their emergence suggests that the current build has been refined to isolate what management views as continuing operations from the cost of specific activities undertaken during the period. The prominence of these newly expanded addbacks, taken as a share of the total adjustment set, is notable because it signals that the current Adjusted EBITDA presentation contains a larger element of judgment regarding the non-recurring nature of those costs than the prior-period schedules did. A careful reader should therefore look behind those characterizations rather than treat the addbacks as routine.

Conversely, one addback category that appeared regularly in the Company's prior-period presentations has disappeared entirely from the current schedule: an adjustment relating to management's estimate of margin disruption attributable to an operational event. Management has explained that the disruption did not recur in the current period, and the removal is plausible on its face. The elimination of that recurring adjustment is directionally supportive of the durability of the earnings base, but it also reduces comparability with earlier periods because those prior schedules included a negative item that is no longer available as a contextual reference. Without that reference, the current composition should be read as reflecting a cleaner, but not necessarily a more conservative, presentation of Adjusted EBITDA.

Taken together, the composition shift suggests that the current Adjusted EBITDA presentation is more heavily weighted toward discrete, event-driven addbacks and less reliant on the recurring owner-related and ordinary-course items that supported prior-period EBITDA builds. To a sophisticated reader, that is a mixed signal. On one hand, the reduced weight of recurring addbacks can be interpreted as a sign that the Company's core operations have become less dependent on owner-specific adjustments. On the other hand, the introduction of several new one-time adjustments creates greater risk that the current Adjusted EBITDA level overstates the maintainable earnings ability of the business, particularly if those items are not in fact non-recurring or if similar costs arise under the Buyer's

ownership. The Buyer should focus its remaining financial and operational due diligence on the underlying drivers of the newly prominent addbacks and on the Company's own documentation of why those items will not recur before placing full reliance on the headline Adjusted EBITDA figure.

SECTION 7.3. Sensitivity of the Headline Figure to Tier Classification Judgments

The headline figure is not a single point estimate that is indifferent to the tiering choices made in this analysis. Because the tier framework assigns each adjustment to a category that carries an evidentiary and a temporal connotation, moving an item from one tier to another changes the way the headline figure should be read, even if the underlying amount is left unchanged. A Tier Two item is, by definition, quantified and judgmental: the adjustment is supported by enough evidence to be measured, but the measurement depends on assumptions about sustainability or causality that are not directly observable. If such an item were instead treated as Tier Three, the headline figure would no longer carry that same judgmental weight; the item would be presented as a pro forma or run-rate effect that the Buyer could model separately from the historical result. The practical sensitivity is therefore one of composition and reliability, not merely of arithmetic.

The converse movement would have an equally meaningful effect. Were a Tier Three item, which is inherently pro forma or run-rate, to be reclassified as Tier Two, the headline figure would appear to rest on a quantified judgment about the historical period rather than on a forward-looking assumption. That reclassification would tend to make the headline figure seem more grounded in actual operating performance than the evidence would otherwise support, because a run-rate item carries with it no direct factual benchmark in the same way that a Tier Two item is expected to carry. The reader would lose the separate visual and conceptual treatment that the framework is designed to provide, and the headline figure would become more vulnerable to the criticism that it merges realized results with modeled expectations.

The treatment of the item for which no second source was identified is a distinct source of sensitivity. This firm did not locate a second source to corroborate that item, and the item is flagged to the Buyer as unsupported. Were the unsupported memo item instead included as a quantified adjustment within the headline figure, the headline figure would change by the full amount of that item, but the change would be one for which no independent corroboration exists. Given the absence of a second source, the Buyer should not treat that amount as if it carried the same evidentiary weight as the Tier One items or as the better-supported Tier Two items. The most defensible reading of the headline figure is one that does not silently incorporate an unsupported amount, regardless of the mechanical effect that inclusion would have.

Taken together, the tier classification judgments affect the headline figure in a way that cannot be reduced to a simple downside or upside range. The sensitivity is primarily qualitative: the headline figure becomes more or less credible, more or less tied to the observed historical data, and more or less dependent on management's forward-looking representations depending on where the lines are drawn. The Buyer should therefore read the headline figure together with the tier assignments themselves, because the tier assignments are not neutral labels; they are an integral part of the analytical conclusion and should be given no less weight than the numerical result.

SECTION 7.4. Cross-Reference to the Adjusted EBITDA Bridge Workbook

The Adjusted EBITDA Bridge workbook serves as the underlying calculation engine for this engagement. Within that workbook, each adjustment identified in our analysis is modeled through a controlled set of linked schedules that aggregate the base EBITDA build, apply the appropriate tier classification, and produce the adjusted EBITDA reconciliation that supports the headline figure presented elsewhere in this document. The workbook is designed to preserve arithmetic integrity through cell-level formulas, explicit period designations, and a clear audit trail from source data to final output. As such, it is the sole repository for the quantitative mechanics of the reconciliation, and any figure appearing in this narrative should be understood as a reference to the workbook’s computed result rather than as an independent calculation.

This narrative analysis, by contrast, is the narrative record of judgment and support. It documents the rationale for each adjustment, the basis for its tier classification, the nature of the underlying evidence, and any limitations or qualifications that we identified during our procedures. Where the workbook quantifies, this narrative explains. That division of labor is intentional: the tables within this document refer to the workbook for amounts and periods, while the narrative sections describe why an adjustment was made, how it was evaluated against the available support, and what residual risks remain for the Buyer’s consideration. A reader seeking the reasoning behind a particular adjustment should look here; a reader seeking the precise arithmetic should look to the workbook.

Because the narrative necessarily summarizes and contextualizes, it is not a substitute for the workbook in any respect where the two might appear to diverge. Narrative descriptions of an adjustment’s effect are framed in qualitative terms and deliberately avoid restating figures, since the workbook contains the definitive computed values. If a discrepancy were to arise between this narrative and the workbook, the workbook should control for all arithmetic purposes. That convention protects the integrity of the reconciliation by ensuring that no narrative interpretation can overwrite a formula-driven result, and it also allows the narrative to discuss judgment and support without inadvertently introducing a computational error.

The Buyer should therefore treat the Adjusted EBITDA Bridge workbook as the arithmetic source of truth for the reconciliation. This narrative is best used as a companion document that explains the context, evidentiary basis, and analytical reasoning behind the adjustments already reflected in the workbook. In reviewing the proposed acquisition,

the Buyer and its lenders should rely on the workbook for all quantitative outcomes and use this narrative to evaluate the quality of the underlying support and the appropriateness of the judgments applied. Any future updates to the analysis should be made in the workbook first, with corresponding narrative adjustments made only to maintain consistency with the workbook’s recomputed results.

SECTION 8. SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS

This analysis was prepared based on unaudited management-prepared information, the audited financial statements for the fiscal year presented, the interim management accounts, and discussions with Company management. We did not audit, review, or compile the underlying financial information in accordance with standards established by the American Institute of Certified Public Accountants or the Public Company Accounting Oversight Board, and we express no opinion or other form of assurance on such information. Our procedures were substantially less in scope than an audit.

The adjusted EBITDA build, the addback schedule and the synergy commentary in this analysis were prepared to support the Buyer's purchase-price diligence on the negotiated multiple; they are not covenant-compliance work product and address no earn-out test under any governing agreement, and their use and distribution are restricted to the Buyer side except as the transmittal letter accompanying this engagement's work product permits.

SECTION 8.1. Expanded Limitations - Reliance on Management

This section expands on the scope of our reliance on management-prepared information and representations in connection with the adjusted EBITDA analysis. As is customary in a due diligence investigation, the Company's management prepared and provided the financial statements, underlying books and records, schedules, supporting documentation, and written responses to our inquiries. We performed procedures designed to assess the reasonableness and internal consistency of that information, but we did not audit or review the Company's financial statements, nor did we express any form of assurance on the financial statements as a whole. Accordingly, our analysis is necessarily conditioned on the completeness and integrity of the information management provided, and that limitation is inherent in the nature of the work.

With respect to completeness, we sought to identify the full universe of items relevant to the adjusted EBITDA analysis through targeted inquiries of management and legal counsel, requests for board meeting minutes, significant contracts, related-party transactions, contingent liabilities, and subsequent events, and reconciliations between internal management reporting and the general ledger. We also reviewed data room indices and request lists and compared certain details to supporting documentation. These procedures are intended to surface omissions, but they cannot prove the absence of unrecorded or undisclosed items. We did not independently search public records or third-party databases, and we did not create an independent population against which to test whether management's disclosure of all relevant matters was complete. In the absence of such a population, our completeness conclusions are based on management's representations and on the absence of inconsistencies within the information we examined.

The distinction between completeness and accuracy is important to the limitations described here. Accuracy testing involves determining whether recorded amounts are correctly stated and appropriately supported; we performed that testing on specific items by vouching to source documents and recalculating contracts or schedules. Completeness testing, by contrast, requires determining whether all items that should be present are actually present. That determination is more difficult and is not susceptible to the same documentary verification. We relied on management to identify all items affecting the EBITDA definition, including known trends, unusual charges, non-recurring events, and related-party arrangements, and we did not assume that the absence of a disclosed matter is conclusive evidence of its nonexistence.

Given the reliance on management-prepared information, the Buyer should treat this report as a decision-making aid rather than an independent certification of completeness. We recommend that the Buyer obtain its own customary management representations and indemnification rights in the acquisition agreement with respect to the accuracy and completeness of the information management provided. We have noted in the relevant sections of this report where management's inability or unwillingness to provide a complete universe of documentation limited our procedures. Those limitations should be considered when assessing the reliance that can be placed on the adjusted EBITDA analysis and the adjustments described herein.

SECTION 8.2. Expanded Limitations - Absence of Independent Verification

Our engagement consisted of analytical and inquiry-based procedures applied to the Company's base EBITDA build and the adjustments recorded in the accompanying tables. It was not an audit or a review, and it was not performed in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards or standards for attestation engagements. Consequently, we do not express an opinion or any other form of assurance on the financial statements or on the EBITDA presentation, and no inference should be drawn that a broader scope would have produced the same adjustments. Where this document uses terms such as verified or confirmed, that language refers to internal consistency from available documentary evidence, not to independent confirmation by third parties.

An audit would have included a systematic assessment of internal control over financial reporting, including tests of controls over transaction initiation, authorization, recording, and reconciliation. Those tests would have allowed an auditor to assess whether the Company's systems and processes were likely to generate complete and accurate

financial information on a repeatable basis. For example, control testing would consider whether revenue cutoff was governed by documented shipping terms, whether disbursements were approved in accordance with a policy, and whether manual journal entries were subject to review. Our procedures did not include such test-of-controls work. We did not evaluate the design or operating effectiveness of the Company's internal controls, and we did not rely on a control-based approach to narrow the extent of our substantive procedures. Instead, we applied targeted procedures to selected transactions and accounts that bore on the adjustments, with the selection based on our own risk assessment and data availability.

An audit also would have included external confirmations and direct communication with third parties. Auditors commonly confirm cash and debt balances with financial institutions, receivable balances and terms with customers, payable balances with vendors, and significant transactions and contingencies with legal counsel and other counterparties. Confirmation procedures provide evidence from sources independent of the Company, which is particularly relevant to the existence, rights and obligations, and completeness assertions underlying a financial presentation. This engagement did not send confirmations. Our evidence was principally obtained from the data room, management-provided schedules, and source documents such as contracts, invoices, and bank statements. While these documents can be persuasive, they are not independent, and the absence of external confirmation increases the risk that the underlying data may be incomplete or inaccurate.

Finally, where the tables identify an adjustment as unsupported because no second source was identified, that flag should be read in light of the limitations described above. In those instances, our inquiry and inspection of management-provided materials did not yield a corroborating source independent of the Company, and we have not otherwise attempted to obtain external verification. We are therefore unable to substantiate the adjustment beyond the information made available to us, and we have presented the item to the Buyer for its own evaluation. The Buyer and its lenders should consider whether additional procedures, such as confirmations or control testing, are warranted before relying on the unsupported item in covenant calculations or purchase price determinations.

SECTION 8.3. Expanded Limitations - Use Restrictions

This analysis was prepared solely for the Buyer's internal use in connection with its evaluation of the proposed transaction, and it is a confidential work product of this Firm. It was neither prepared nor intended for any third party, and it should not be read as a general assessment of the Company's creditworthiness or future prospects. A third party who obtains a copy of this analysis without the Firm's consent lacks the full context of the engagement, including the scope of the procedures performed, the specific information relied upon, the representations made by Company management, and the adjustments and supporting schedules that frame each calculation. Because that context is indispensable to a proper reading of the analysis, any such third party should not act or refrain from acting on the basis of the document.

A recipient outside the engagement would also lack access to the Firm's working papers and would have no opportunity to question the responsible engagement professionals about the methodology, the assumptions applied, or the weight assigned to particular evidence. The conclusions reflected in this analysis are judgment-based and were formed for the Buyer's specific purposes under the proposed structure, and they necessarily incorporate professional judgments exercised as of the time of the fieldwork. An unrelated party seeking to apply the analysis for a different purpose, in a different transaction context, or at a later date would be using the document in a manner that exceeds its intended scope. In this Firm's view, any such use would be inherently unreliable and is therefore inappropriate.

When the Buyer's lenders are permitted access to this analysis, a customary non-reliance letter serves to define the only permissible terms of that access. By executing such a letter, the lenders acknowledge that the analysis was not prepared for their benefit and that they have not relied on it in making their own credit decisions, while also confirming that they will perform their own independent evaluation and diligence. The non-reliance letter further records the understanding that this Firm makes no representation or warranty to the lenders concerning the accuracy, completeness, or sufficiency of the analysis and owes the lenders no duty of care in connection with its preparation or their receipt of it.

In this way, the non-reliance letter preserves the intended architecture of the engagement, under which this Firm's responsibilities run exclusively to the Buyer, while still permitting the Buyer's financing process to proceed without the lenders being left with an actionable claim arising from their receipt or perusal of the document. The letter also provides an evidentiary record that no advisory relationship was created between this Firm and the lending syndicate, thereby confining this Firm's exposure to the party with whom it actually contracted. Absent such a letter, the analysis could be misused as a substitute for the lenders' own diligence, a result that neither this Firm nor the Buyer contemplates.

SECTION 8.4. Concluding Observations for the Buyer

The analysis has identified several areas where the Buyer's ability to rely on the adjusted EBITDA build depends on documentation that was not fully available at the time of drafting. The most efficient next step is to obtain, for each Tier One adjustment, the original source document from which the adjustment was derived, together with any reconciliations prepared by the Company's accounting personnel. Where the underlying contract or invoice has been superseded or amended, the Buyer should request the complete chain of amendments so that the adjustment can be verified against the terms in effect during the relevant period. That documentation request is straightforward and

should be directed to the Company's finance function before the purchase agreement is finalized.

For Tier Two adjustments, the critical need is not additional source data but a clear written explanation of the judgments applied. Management should be asked to prepare a narrative memorandum describing the business purpose of each item, the basis for treating it as non-recurring or non-operating, and the specific contract or event that caused the charge or credit. The Buyer should also request any board materials, contemporaneous emails, or external advice that support the characterization, because those materials will demonstrate whether the judgment was formed as events occurred rather than reconstructed for the transaction. If the Company cannot produce such materials, the Buyer should weigh the resulting lack of corroboration in its own underwriting rather than assuming the adjustment will survive a lender's review.

For Tier Three adjustments, the most efficient diligence step is to require a documented implementation plan for each run-rate item, including the specific operational actions to be taken, the individuals responsible, and the expected timing of completion. Management should also be asked to reconcile each run-rate adjustment to a current baseline so the Buyer can see the bridge from actual performance to the projected state. Where the adjustment depends on a contract or a capital investment, the Buyer should request the executed agreement or commitment letter, and where it depends on a future decision, the Buyer should seek evidence of board approval or a formal budget allocation. The classification of these items between cost savings and revenue enhancements under the governing schedule remains a matter for the Buyer and its advisers to apply, and the documentation should be organized so that classification can be tested without further clarification from the Company.

Finally, the Buyer should close the remaining gap for any adjustment that remains without a corroborating second source. In that situation, the most efficient request is a direct inquiry to the Company for the second source, not a request for management to re-confirm the same underlying data. The Buyer should ask whether an independent record exists with a counterparty, a tax authority, a regulator, or a third-party service provider, and if so, obtain it directly. Where no such source exists, the Buyer should treat the adjustment as unsupported and make its own determination about the appropriate level of reliance, without asking management to certify the item a second time.